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Grade Proposal

WRIT 340

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66837

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1 Claim

1.1 Proposal

I propose an A grade for this WRIT 340 course.

1.2 Meeting Baseline Requirements

I have met all baseline grading contract requirements for a B which were:

- **Missed no more than four classes**

I attended all classes so far this semester.

- **No more than 3 late assignments**

I have not submitted any assignments later than the due date or extended due date.

- **No more than 1 missed assignments**

I have not missed any assignments.

- **Zero ignored assignments**

I did not ignore any assignments.

1.3 Fulfillment of Individual Learning Plan (ILP) Revised Goals for A

My revised goals for an A building off my ILP are:

Original Goals

1. Consistent effort to improve reading and writing skills in support of personal and professional development
2. Regularly revising work based on feedback and showing clear progress and improvement over the term
3. Actively exploring new ways to build skills and develop better habits
4. Demonstrating strong engagement in class and a clear commitment to growth

Added Goals

1. Staying up to date with current events and technologies in my related field and hobbies

Removed Goals

1. Completing assignments early to allow time for reflection and revision

I removed this goal because it overlaps with #2 from Original Goals. Revising work regularly already requires completing work with enough time to reflect and improve upon it.

I believe I have fulfilled all of my revised ILP goals and have therefore earned an A in this course. The following Discussion section examines how my work this term fulfills each of these goals, supported by documentation in the Appendix.

2 Discussion

2.1 Goal #1

The Goal

Consistent effort to improve reading and writing skills in support of personal and professional development

2.1.1 Learning L^AT_EX & Writing Technical Deliverables in CSCI 401

One of the most significant writing efforts I undertook this semester was learning L^AT_EX to produce all 4 technical deliverables for my CSCI 401 Capstone: Design and Construction of Large Software Systems course. While L^AT_EX was not required (many teams just used Word Docx or Google Docs), I took it upon myself to learn it because I recognized in past classes and internships that presentation matters significantly in formal/presentation documents. A well formatted document communicates a thousand things including competence, care, and commitment, even before a reader gets to the actual content. I wanted to ensure our deliverables reflected that dedication to the project (see Appendix A).

The Learning curve was real. Writing a document in code felt counterintuitive at first (and definitely enraging, I already have to write actual code so it felt like over complicating my life), but seeing how markup language could produce such clean and professional documents made the effort completely worth it. Through iterative learning and development, I was able to work through it. With a combination of leveraging online resources, videos, and AI tools, I was able to learn super quickly and learn unique ways on solving such minor problems (e.g. making lists, headers, footers). What made it more challenging was that a good portion of the content came from my 4 other teammates, so I had to regularly check in with them to understand what each component of the project actually accomplished before I could write about it accurately. The process of reading, analyzing, and writing about technical work I did not always build myself pushed me to develop a much sharper workflow and genuinely supported my personal and professional development. In my past internship, Amazon had such a plethora of documentation, but reading and understanding it was so tiresome and difficult. However, by being the individual who made the documentation, I am able to see this entire process through a unique perspective.

The stakeholder communication that accompanied these deliverables was equally instructive. I tried applying skills from my past internships writing design documents alongside what I had been learning in WRIT 340, but it was more difficult than I expected. Our client was not a technical stakeholder, and I quickly ran into a habit I had not fully recognized in myself. I was overcomplicating my writing with technical terminology and jargon. This resulted in the stakeholder requiring a lot of clarification. Therefore, I took the time to rewrite and reexplain in plainer but still equally informative language. This whole process demonstrated to me that writing is much more than just flexing your brain muscles, but actually about the end consumer and making it accessible.

WRIT 340 was eye opening in this regard. I came to understand that big complicated words do not make a document better. They convolute the subject and make it harder to understand. I am 100% guilty of this. I reach for complex vocabulary when simpler words would have served the same purpose and reader far better. This habit will be on the forefront of my head from now on through this experience. Styling and organization also played a bigger role than I anticipated. The stakeholder was impressed with how our deliverables looked, which went a long way in building credibility. However, getting the structure to actually make sense to a non-technical reader required real back and forth, and that clarification process taught me just as much as the writing itself did.

2.1.2 Independent Reading

Outside of coursework, I made a deliberate effort this semester to read more consistently in support of my personal and professional development. My sister and father are both booked enthusiasts and I've always inspired me to read, but more importantly I recognize that once I join the workforce and leave academia, it will become increasingly rare to learn something outside of my immediate field, which is computer science I also didn't want to develop a habit of only reading things. I enjoyed military history or science fiction so I pushed myself to read something educational (see Appendix B).

I started with "How to Lie with Statistics" by Darrell Huff. I chose it primarily because of its length and chapter structure, around 150 pages with short chapters that get to the point. I absolutely cannot stand books with long drawn out chapters that obscure the main point, so this felt like the perfect place to build a good reading habit. The book itself was incredibly informative and eye opening especially for being such a fun little looking book. It made it clear that everyone who uses statistics is, no matter what, unconsciously biased. People frequently cherry pick their sources and data to support their viewpoint. The book gave me practical tools to view data more critically and reminded me how easy it is to manipulate correlations into misleading causations, or as the book calls it, statisticulate. It also gave simple methods to catch dishonest use of statistics, like simply stepping back and asking yourself whether something actually makes sense.

The experience also revealed some bad habits. I had not fully confronted before. I kept catching myself reading, unconsciously, realizing I have not absorbed anything and having to start the paragraph over again it wasted so much time. I also struggled to maintain a consistent reading habit. I started off strong and got through half of the book in about a week, but then it completely fell apart. It took me almost 2 months to finish the 150 page book which was incredibly humbling.

Then I moved on, and am still reading, "The Anxious Generation" by Jonathan Haidt. I was drawn to it because I am genuinely curious about how digital technology, a relatively new technology in the grand scheme of this world, has shaped recent generations. It is a step up in terms of depth and complexity compared to Huff's book, but it felt like a natural progression. So far what I have found interesting is how differently technology has affected boys and girls. Boys were more heavily impacted by easy access to pornography and the dopamine cycle that comes with it. On the other hand, girls were primarily affected through

social media and the constant self comparison it enabled, which led to significantly higher rates of anxiety. I am genuinely looking forward to continuing it once I have more time.

Beyond books, I also recognized a bad habit I had developed around news consumption. I was absorbing almost everything through short form social media (e.g. reels, shorts) which meant my attention span had gotten pretty bad and the content I was seeing was heavily filtered by algorithms, which easily emotionally charges you. I did not want to keep falling into that trap, so I turned to more reputable sources of media. I downloaded the Wall Street Journal, LA Times, and the New York Times (I was amazed by the resources given to us by this school), and committed to scrolling through at least one of them every day. I was aware that no news source is truly unbiased, they lean some way on the political spectrum, so reading across multiple outlets felt like the more honest approach to staying informed.

I did a pretty good job of sticking to this habit I wanted to develop. Notifications surprisingly helped a lot. Whenever a headline came through that caught my attention I was much more likely to actually read the article, and what helped was that you do not have to read every article in its entirety. Alternating between reading closely and skimming kept it manageable for my ruined brain and attention span.

Overall, this habit genuinely improved my reading in ways I can feel. My attention span is noticeably longer. I am actually able to sit with content now instead of skipping anything that feels too long or slow, and that carries over directly into how I read processional documents and course materials.

2.2 Goal #2

The Goal

Regularly revising work based on feedback and showing clear progress and improvement over the term

2.2.1 Revising Work

One of the most important things I learned this semester is that micro iterative development is what works before me when it comes to revisions. I had a good amount of comments on my assignments throughout the term (I apologize Professor), and I found it genuinely difficult to go from a second draft to a final draft while trying to address everything at once. It was overwhelming to look at a full page of feedback and attempt to tackle it all in one sitting. So instead, I started breaking it down into smaller, more focused revision sessions just like how I code.

My process became something like this. I would take the first few comments, particularly the ones that were more broadly applicable to the entire piece of writing. I then would make those improvements, and move on to the next batch of comments or changed I needed to make. Although this felt inefficient at times because sometimes I kept rewriting the same paragraph over and over again, it was incredibly helpful because it allowed me to give each price of feedback the focused attention it deserved rather than skimming through everything and making surface level changes.

What I am most proud of in this area is that I did not stop revising when the assignment was technically over. For my technical description, even after submitting the final draft, I went back into the document and continued making improvements (see Appendix C). I used the final draft as the foundation, worked through the remaining minor comments, and made additional changes that I felt were necessary. This also spilled over into my other classes like my technical deliverables for CSCI 401 and the website for my father's company.

This methodology in micro iterative development and constantly seeking ways to improve allowed me to make a lot more tangible improvements. Sometimes whenever I am taking too large of a bite, it makes me think of less optimal and targeted solutions.

2.3 Goal #3

The Goal

Actively exploring new ways to build skills and develop better habits

2.3.1 Learning AI Coding Tools

It is very apparent that to stay relevant in software engineering, the field I am pursuing a career in, using AI tools is no longer optional. Companies are already reacting to this reality by laying off a good portion of their workforce in favor of investing those available resources into AI. Oracle, Amazon, and Meta are just a few companies expecting more output with less manpower. With this reality in mind, I made it my mission this semester to get familiar with tools like Cursor and Claude Code so that transitioning into a full-time role for software engineering would be easier in this day and age (see Appendix D).

Initially, I treated AI tools as an automatic Stack Overflow (question-and-answer website where programmers ask, answer, and vote on coding questions) rather than a tool that could actually write code for me. That approach was still incredibly useful. Instead of spending hours manually troubleshooting, I could get to a solution in minutes. However, I deliberately avoided letting AI write full code for me because as a student I knew I would be cheating myself out of an education, and frankly I did not fully trust it yet. I had enough experiences with it hallucinating information or producing code that complementarily missed the point of the prompt, but to be fair, that was with previous generations of AI.

This whole mindset changed when I started coming across videos specifically targeted at software engineers about these newer tools and how to actually use them effectively. Also, my teacher assistance for CSCI 401 encouraged my team to use these AI tools. I began watching these videos and instantly realized these tools were something I had to learn and take seriously. Therefore, I began using Cursor and Claude Code more intentionally, following educational content to fast track my understanding of the most effective methods (see Appendix D).

The impact was instantly noticeable. It completely changed how I approach problems entirely. I stopped thinking about how to write every line of code and granular details in the system's structure. Instead, I started thinking about what I actually wanted to build and how to direct the tools to get there. It also accelerated how quickly I could pick up new frameworks and debug unfamiliar errors.

At the end of the day, I will still instill the sense that knowing how to code is important, but how I approach work is now completely different. I went from writing code to directing and reviewing code, and that is exactly where the industry is headed. I am grateful for making the attempt to explore tools and workflows that were unfamiliar and uncomfortable at first, because now my output is easily five fold (and that's a conservative estimate) of what I was initially capable of. Now I feel like a better engineer and I have created a better habit of learning new tools earlier on which will assist me in my full-time career.

2.3.2 Redesigning the Pralumex Website

To put the skills I was building into real-world practice, I took on the project of redesigning my father's website for his company, Pralumex Inc., a plastic recycling business (see Appendix E.1 for the original site at old.pralumex.com). This was not a class assignment. It was a self-initiated project that pushed me outside of comfort zone as someone who primarily works on the backend side of software development.

I approached it in stages. The first version I built relied heavily on pre-built UI component libraries, which made the process faster but resulted in something that felt generic and cookie cutter (see Appendix E.2, pralumex.com). It definitely worked and was a step up from the older website, but it did not reflect the level of quality I wanted to deliver. So I went back to the drawing board.

I started watching more videos on frontend design and UI/UX principles because that world was genuinely foreign to me (see Appendix F). I have some design background from serving as editor-in-chief for my high school newspaper and magazine, but UI/UX is a completely different field of expertise. That experience at least gave me a foundation to build on, but I had to learn a lot from scratch. I also began leveraging more powerful AI design tools like Claude Design to accelerate the process. However, I made sure to apply the same careful and directed approach I had developed with AI coding tools rather than just letting it generate everything blindly. However, I always ran into issues where I would run out of tokens so development had to be spread out over a few days for some basic changes which was infuriating.

What I learned through this process is that AI can get you to good, but it takes human creativity and judgement to get to great. I made sure to push beyond what the AI suggested and add creative details that made the site feel unique and specific to what Pralumex actually does. The result is currently in testing at beta.pralumex.com (see Appendix E.3).

One aspect of this project I did not anticipate was the writing involved. Adding and rewriting content for the website took considerable time and thought because plastic waste and recycling is a politically and environmentally sensitive topic. I had to be deliberate about how the company positioned itself, and convincing my father on certain wording and messaging required its own back and forth because he was worrisome about being too specific and also politically/environmentally incorrect. The process of reviewing, rewriting, and negotiating to a stakeholder was also incredibly valuable.

2.3.3 Time Management & Productivity Habits

[WORK IN PROGRESS] (see Appendix G)

- Find videos and articles I read regarding Timeboxing and Pomodoro. Also include the weeks I tried using Timeboxing and how that week looked like in my calendar.
- Timeboxing was nice but way too difficult to estimate how long things would be completed. Also, my schedule was sporadic causing me to be super late to start the task

and me having to reschedule many tasks. Todoist made it a lot easier to plan though.

- Pomodoro was nice but I was seriously struggling with my shortened attention span.

2.4 Goal #4

The Goal

Demonstrating strong engagement in class and a clear commitment to growth

2.4.1 Active Participation in Class

One of the more personal growth areas I committed to this semester was speaking up more across all of my classes. This sounds simple, but for me it was genuinely difficult. I get incredibly anxious when trying to articulate my thoughts out loud because what makes perfect sense in my head often comes out as jumbled and unclear when I try to verbalize it. That gap between thinking and speaking has always frustrated me, and I knew it was something I needed to actively work on.

I made a conscious effort across all three of my main courses this semester. In WRIT 340, I pushed myself to contribute during class discussions and group work, particularly during the sessions where we presented our analyses or ideas. In BUAD 497, I tried to engage more consistently with the course content by asking questions and participating in discussions even when I was not entirely confident in what I was about to say. In CSCI 401, I volunteered to be one of the primary communicators with our stakeholder, an actual client, which required speaking professionally and technically in a setting that had real stakes.

What I came to understand through all of this is that most of life does not come with preparation time. You cannot always script what you are going to say before you say it. So I wanted to build the ability to organize my thoughts on the spot in a way that comes out clearly and coherently rather than as a stream of half formed ideas.

The most practical habit I developed was talking through my thoughts out loud while working alone. I noticed that my mind tends to move faster than my mouth, which causes me to rush and lose clarity. Speaking aloud slowed my brain down in a useful way. Over time I started doing something before I spoke up in class or in a meeting. I would give myself a few seconds, recollect my thoughts, quickly identify the main points I wanted to make, and then speak. It sounds small, but it made a noticeable difference.

I still have a lot of room to grow in this area and I know that. But I have so many ideas and perspectives that I genuinely want to share, and this semester I finally started closing the gap between what is in my head and what actually comes out. That is a real commitment to growth, and it is one I intend to carry forward.

2.5 Goal #5

The Goal

Staying up to date with current events and technologies in my related field and hobbies

2.5.1 Following Software & Technology Content

[WORK IN PROGRESS] (see Appendix H)

- Discuss how I maintained staying up to date with tech news through Fireship videos.
- Also, try to find the other tech videos I watched.
- Mention the video by Micro that exposed how private equity firms are purchasing many YouTube and social media channels. Nothing can be trusted anymore.

2.5.2 NTSB Articles & Aviation Crash Investigations

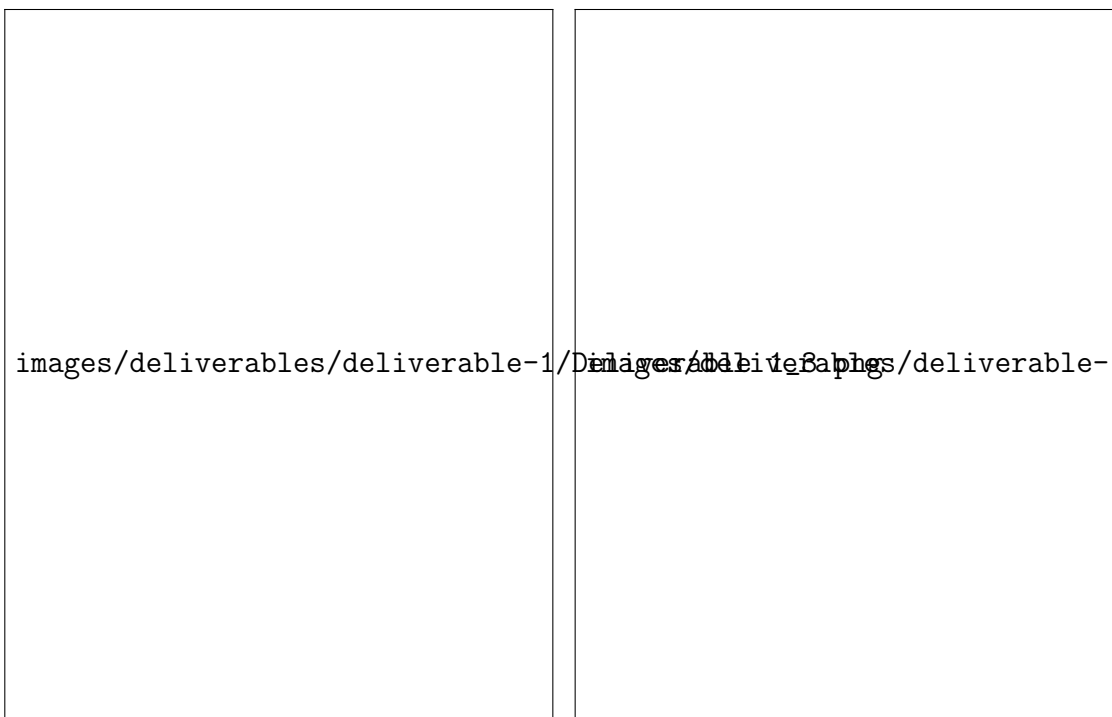
[WORK IN PROGRESS] (see Appendix I)

- Discuss the relevance of watching these videos and articles.
- NTSB has such a wealth of information and such a respected organization. They have amazing articles but their graphics really seal the deal and make analyzing the issue intuitive and accessible. It also helped me with my technical reading skills.
- Mention how I began watching Pilot Debrief regarding accidents closer to general aviation and how it was more applicable to me.

3 Appendix

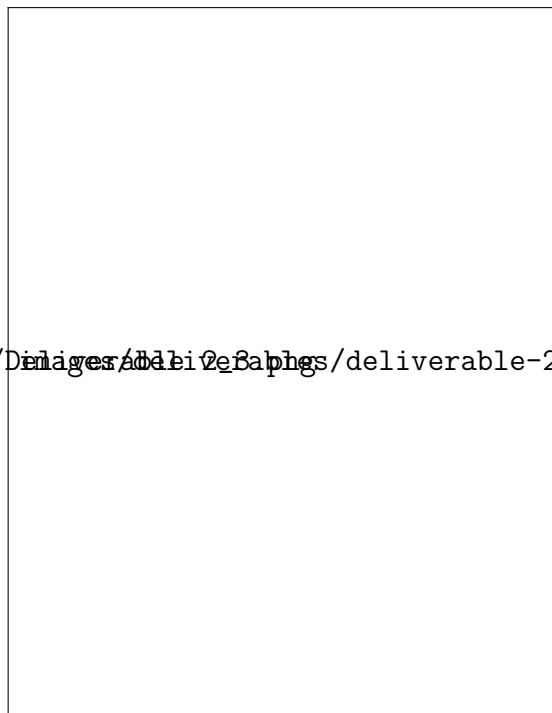
3.1 Appendix A: L^AT_EX Deliverables (CSCI 401, Deliverables 1 through 4)

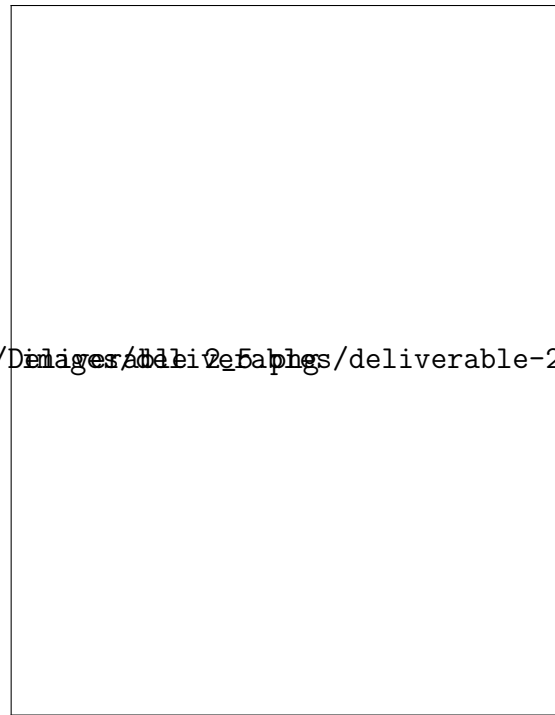
3.1.1 Deliverable 1



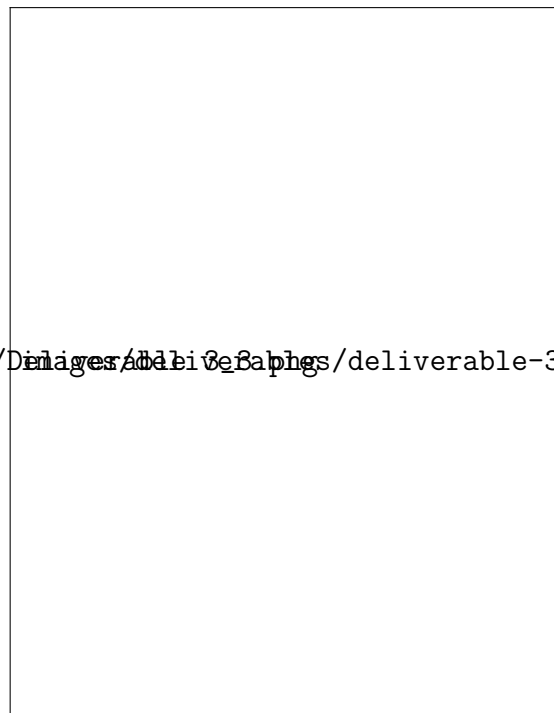


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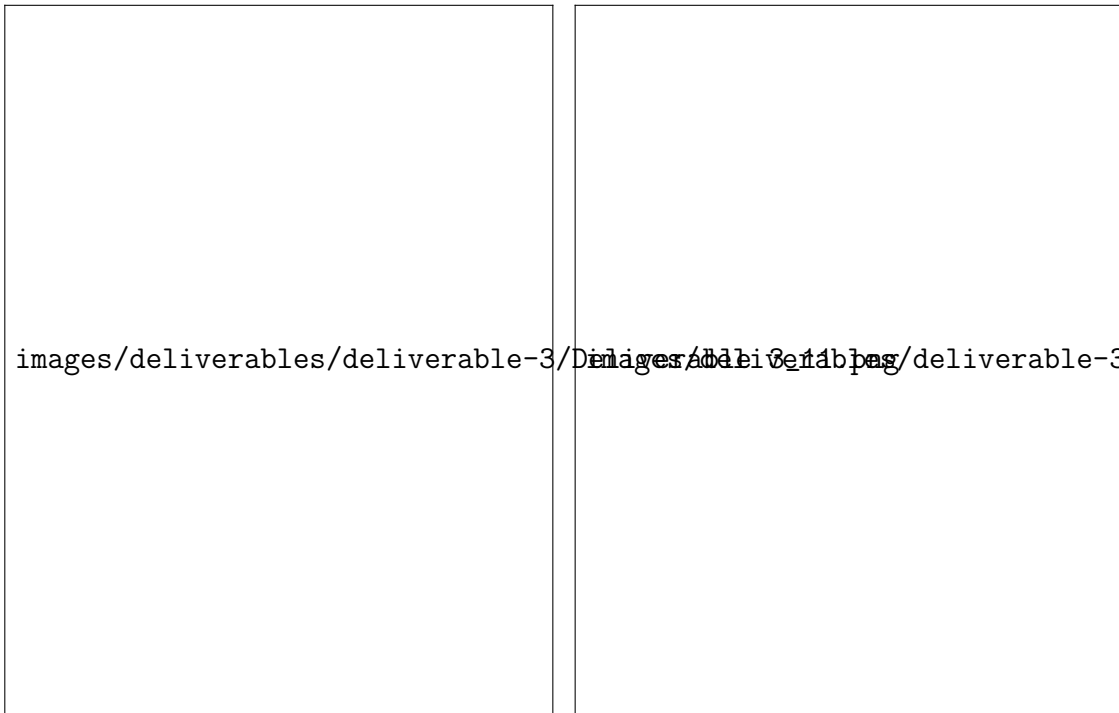




3.1.3 Deliverable 3









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3.1.4 Deliverable 4



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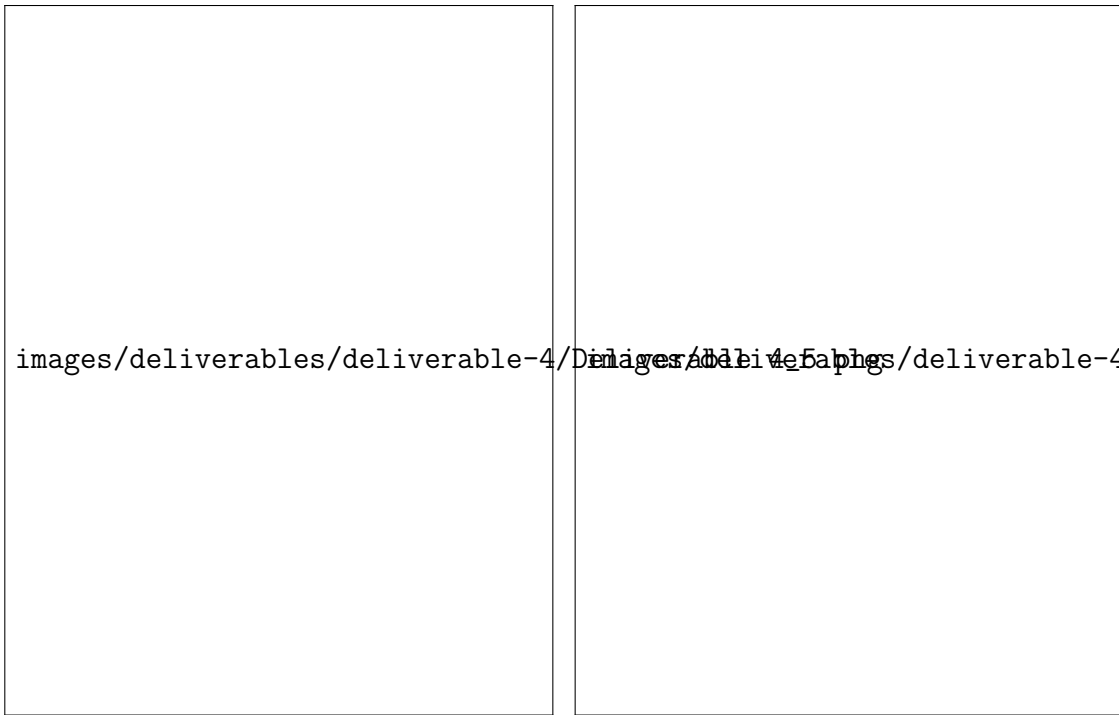
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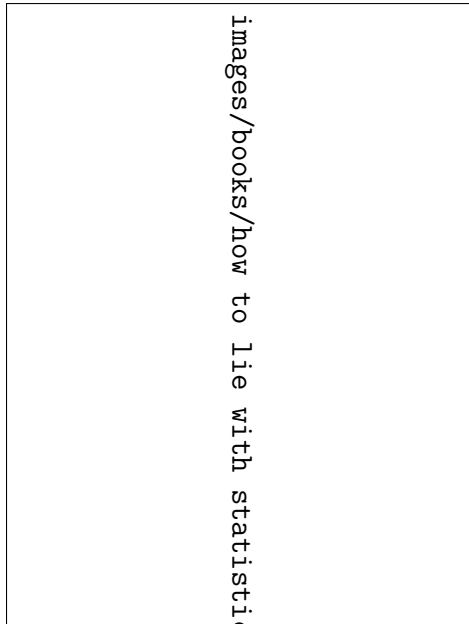
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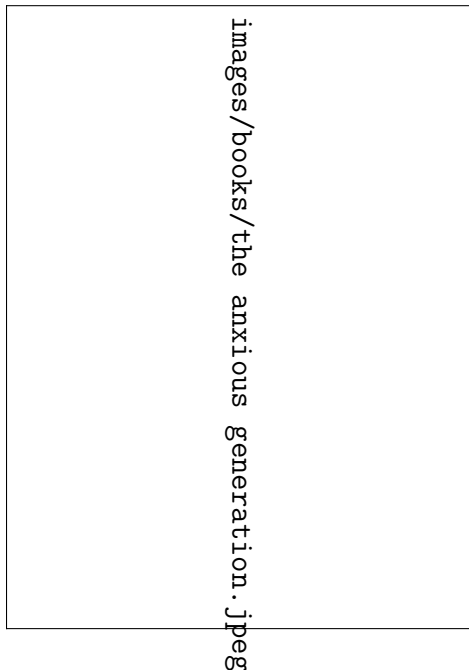
3.2 Appendix B: Reading List & Sources

3.2.1 Books

How to Lie with Statistics by Darrell Huff



The Anxious Generation by Jonathan Haidt



3.3 Appendix C: Micro Revisions of Work

3.3.1 Technical Description

[View on Google Drive](#)



3.3.2 Social Impact of Emerging Technology (SIoT)

[View on Google Drive](#)



3.3.3 Incident Report

[View on Google Drive](#)



images/work-revisions/incident-report.png

3.4 Appendix D: AI Coding Tool Videos & Sources

3.4.1 Claude Code

Title	Creator	Type	Platform
Claude Code Docs	Anthropic	Document	Claude
Learn 80% of Claude Code in 10 Minutes (2026 Tutorial)	Sajjaad Khader	Video	YouTube
Claude Code Tutorial for Beginners	Kevin Stratvert	Video	YouTube
800+ hours of Learning Claude Code in 8 minutes (2026 tutorial)	Edmund Yong	Video	YouTube

3.4.2 Cursor

Title	Creator	Type	Platform
Cursor 2.0 is here... 5 things you didn't know it can do	Fireship	Video	YouTube
Cursor 2.0 — Full Tutorial for Beginners	Tech With Tim	Video	YouTube

3.5 Appendix E: Pralumex Website Screenshots

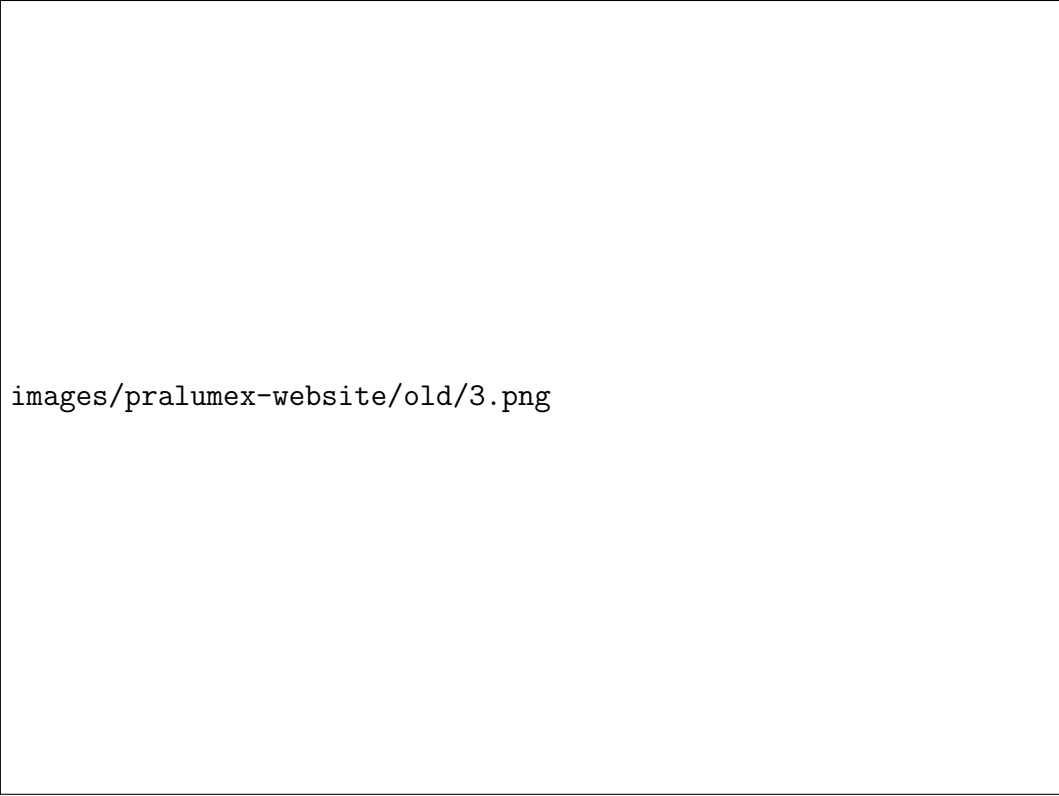
3.5.1 E.1 — Original Site (old.pralumex.com)



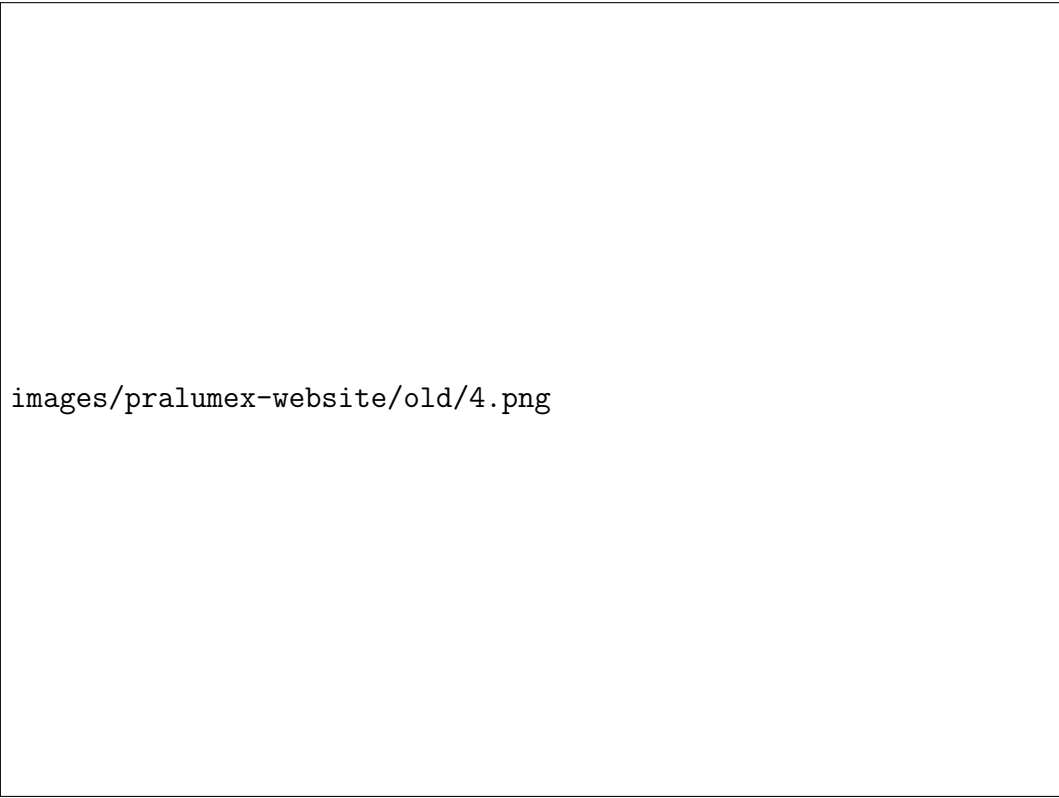
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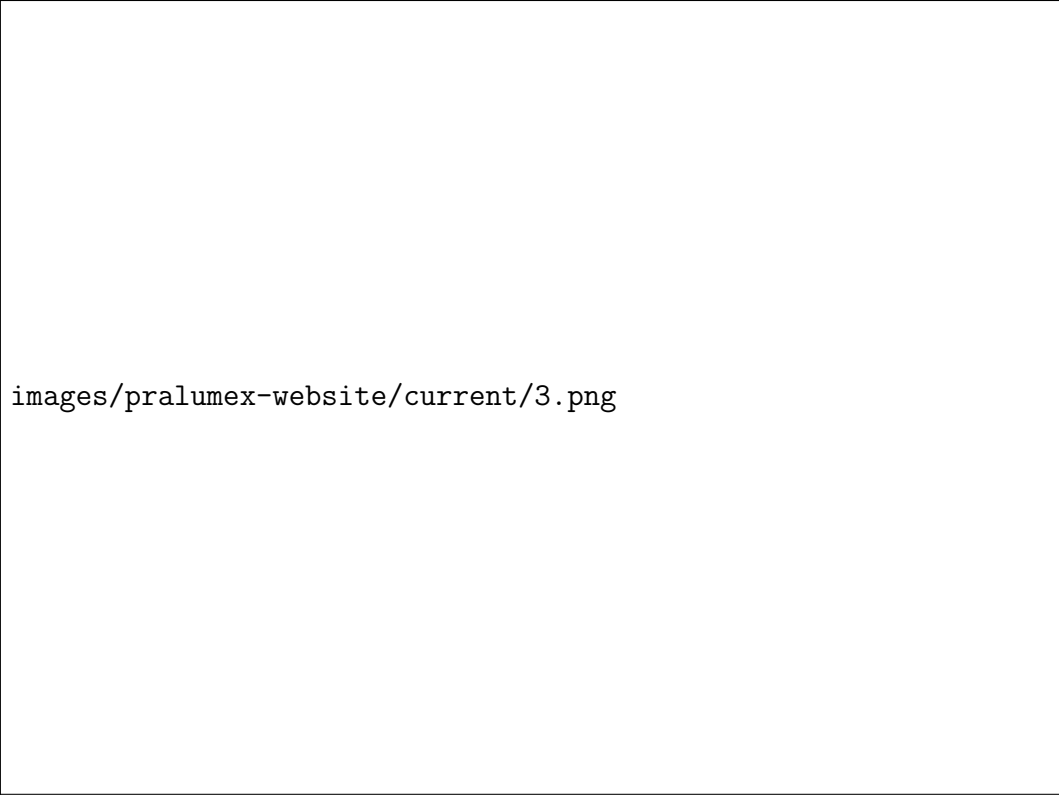
3.5.2 E.2 — Current Site (pralumex.com)



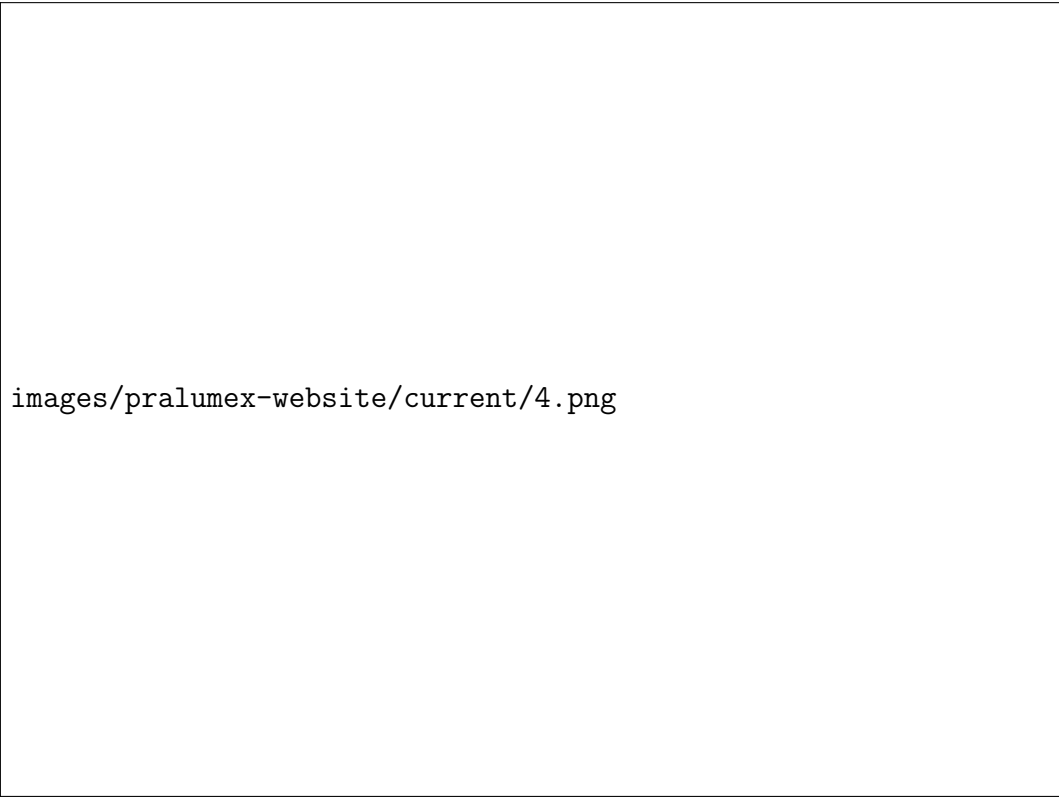
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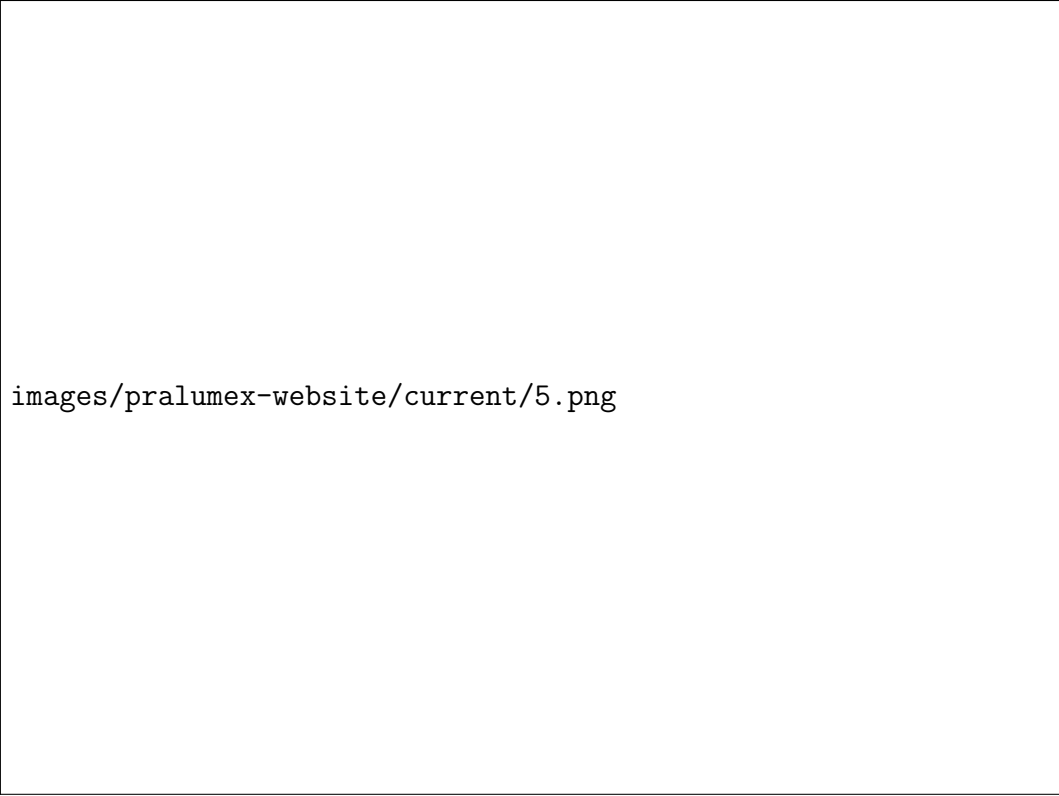
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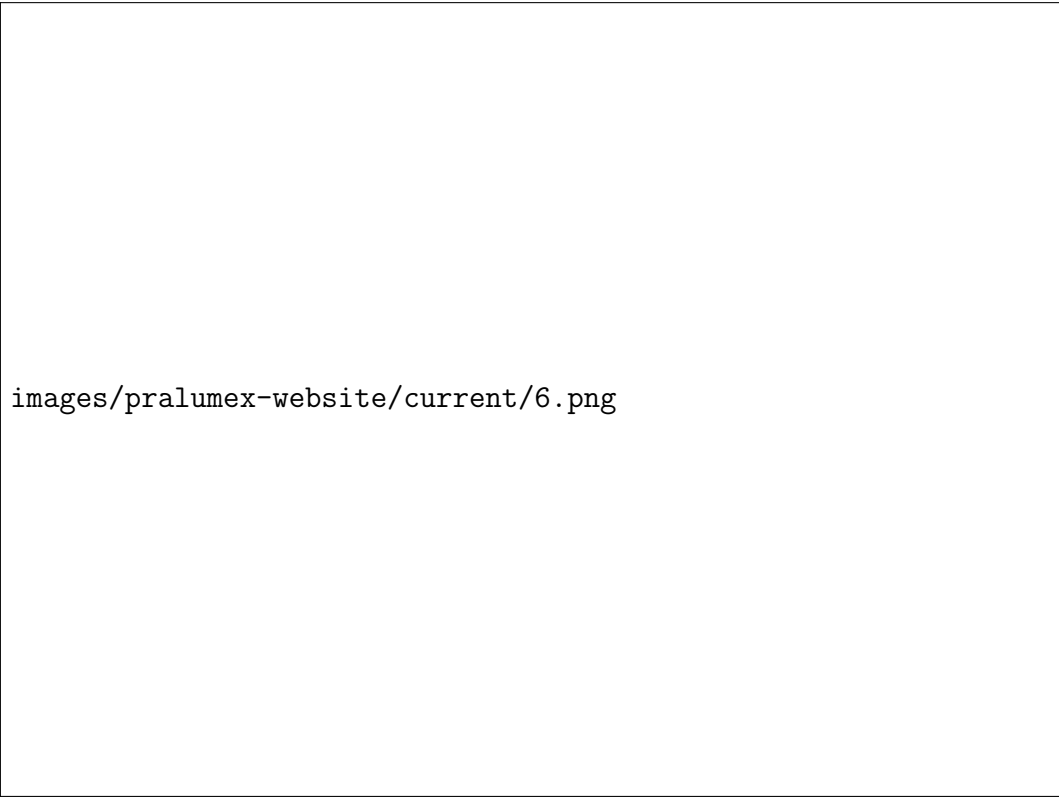
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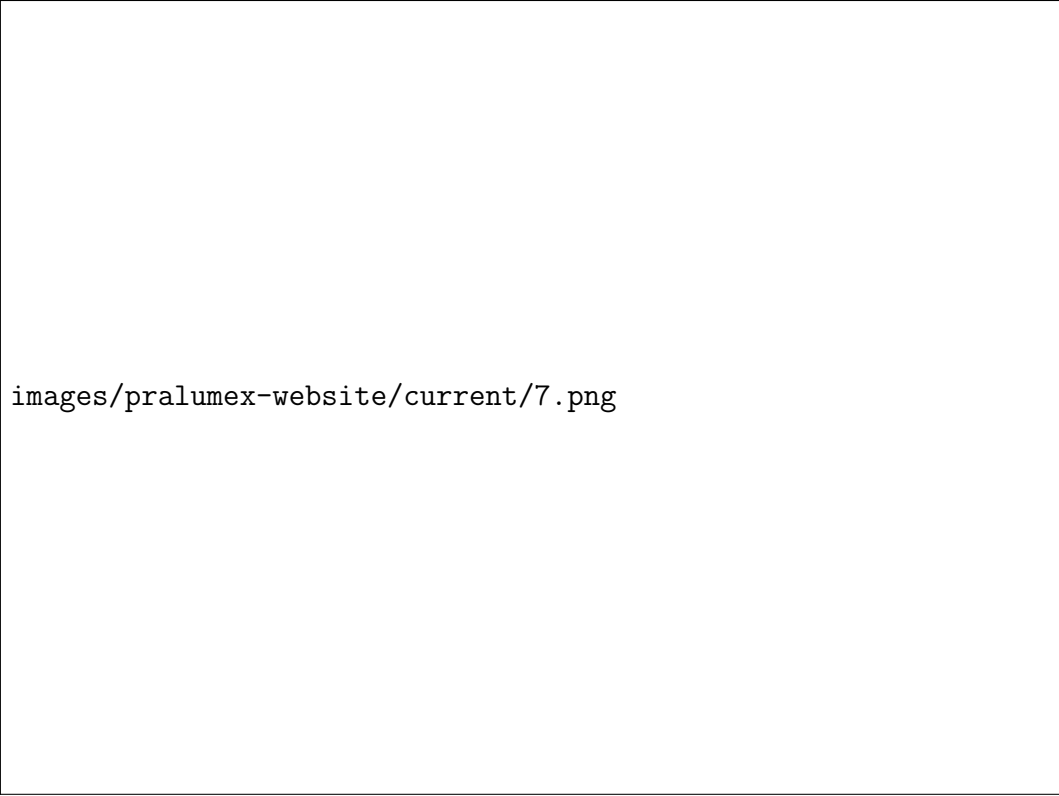
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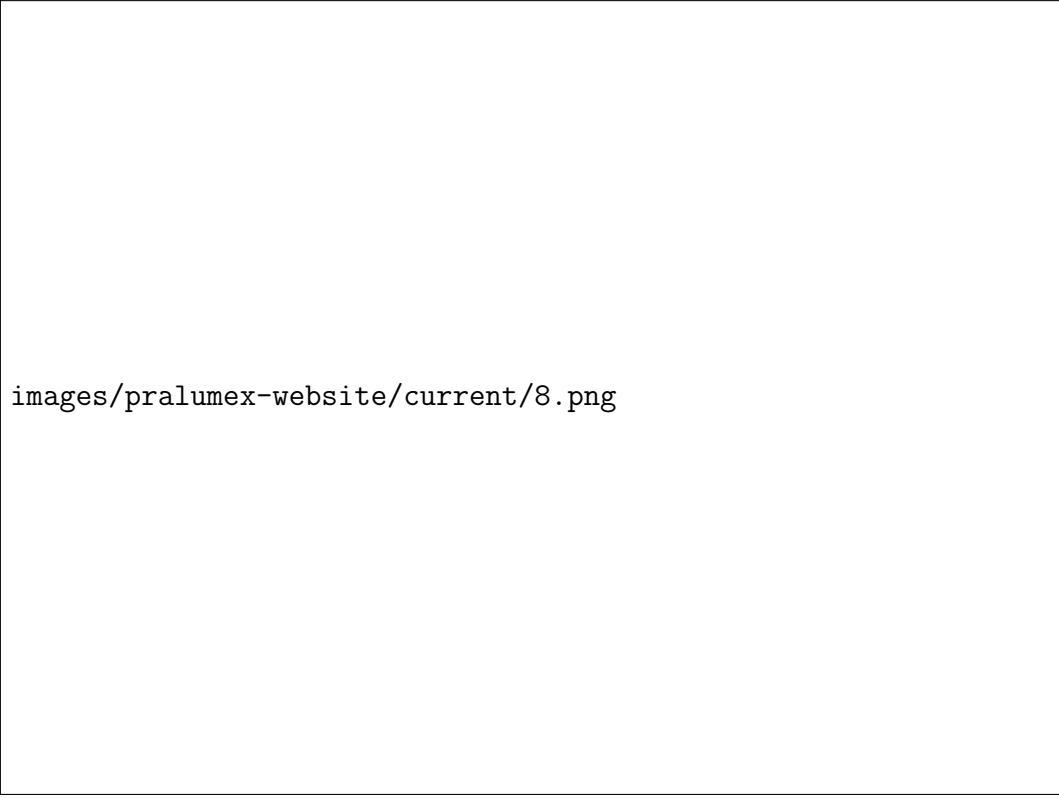
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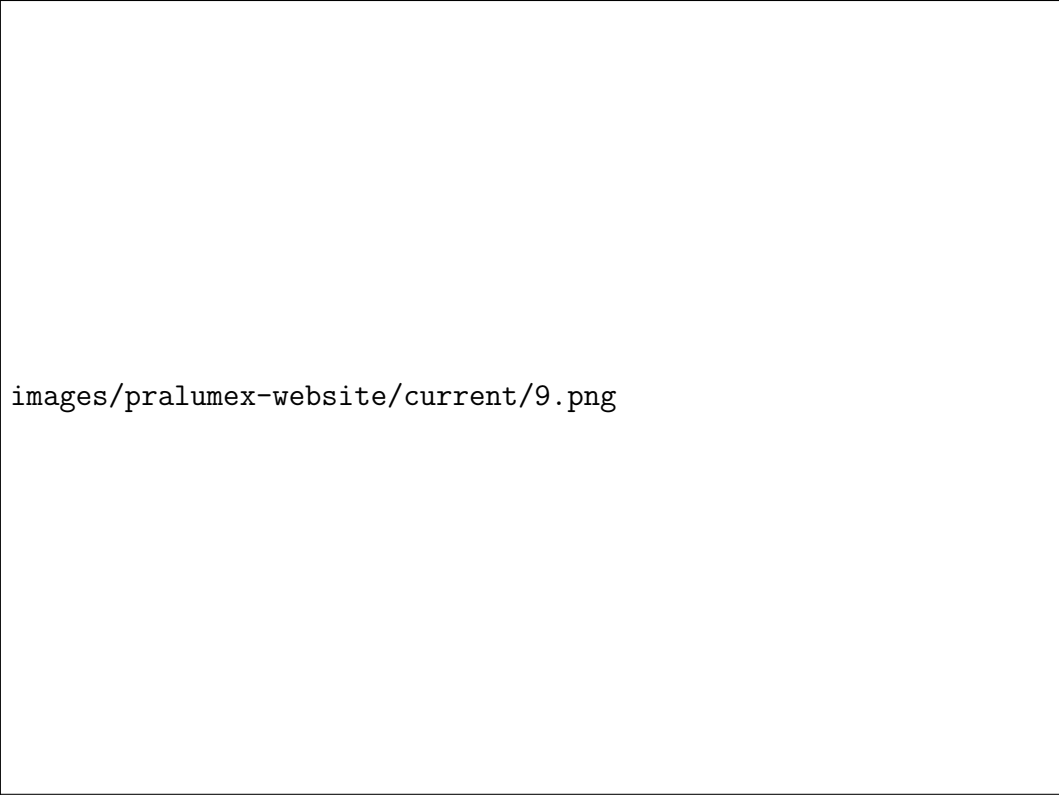
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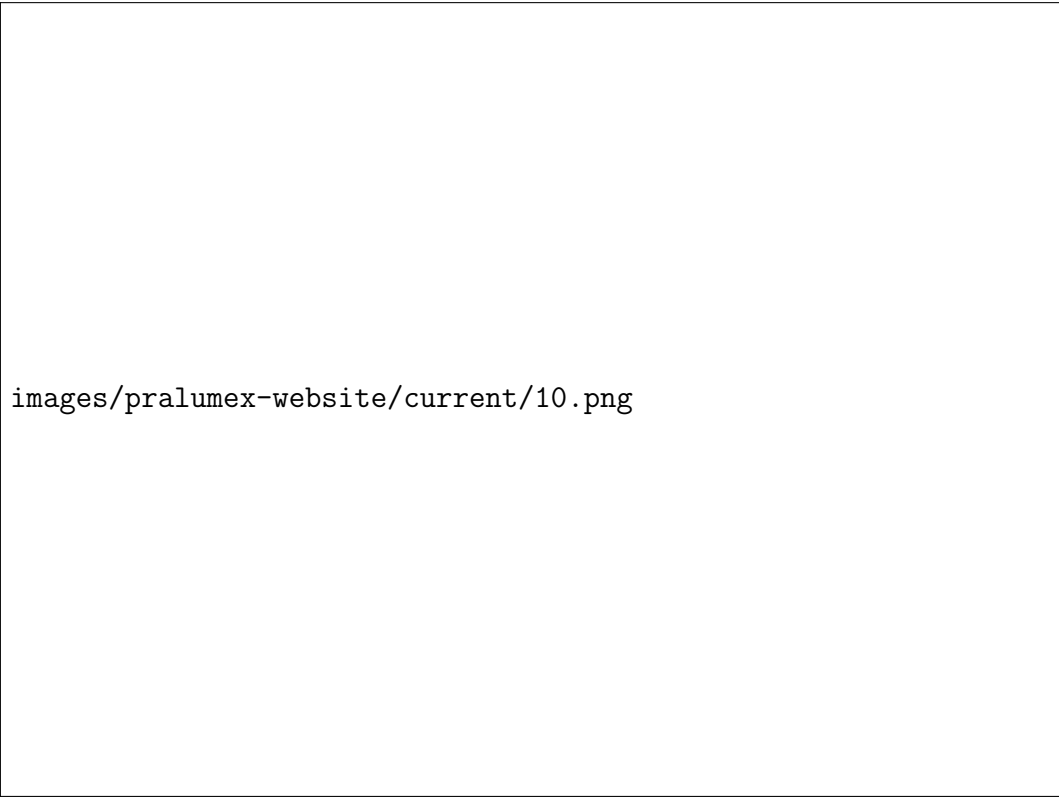
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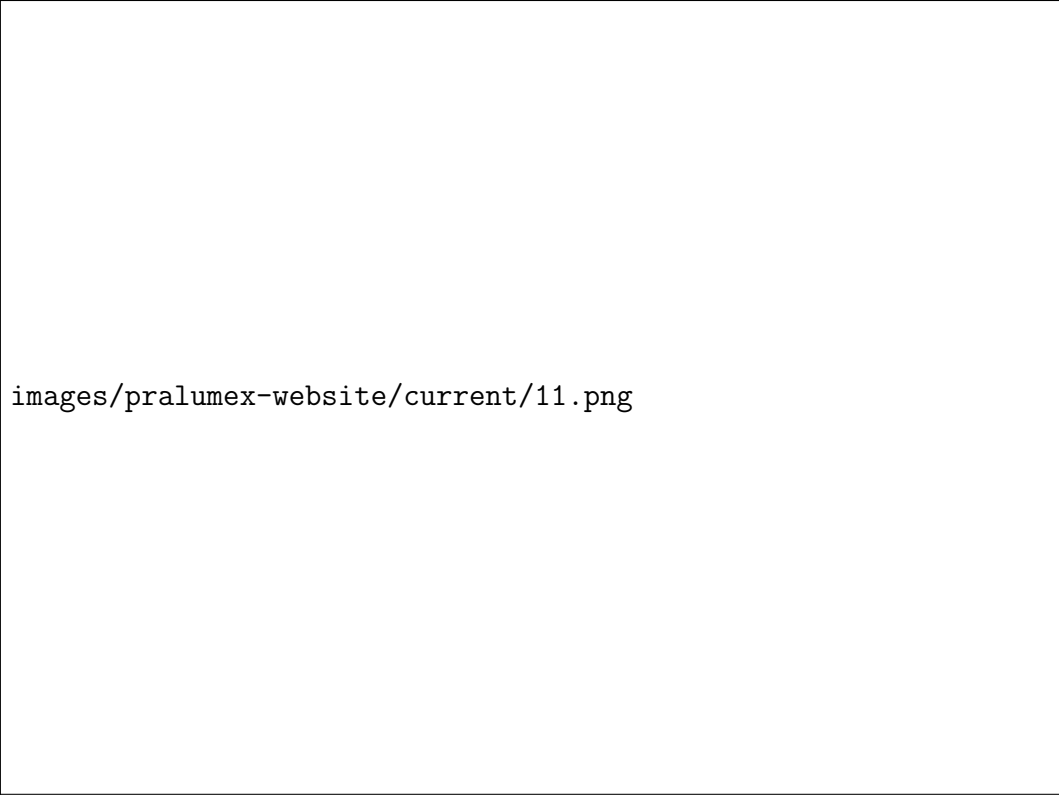
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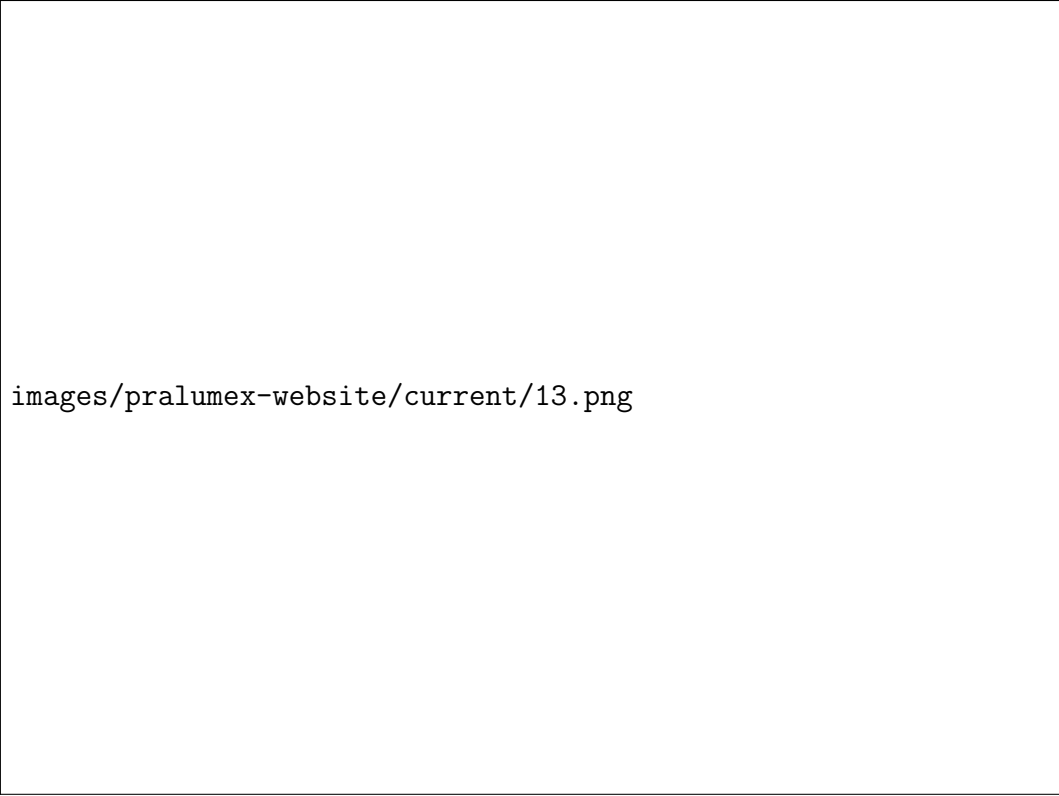
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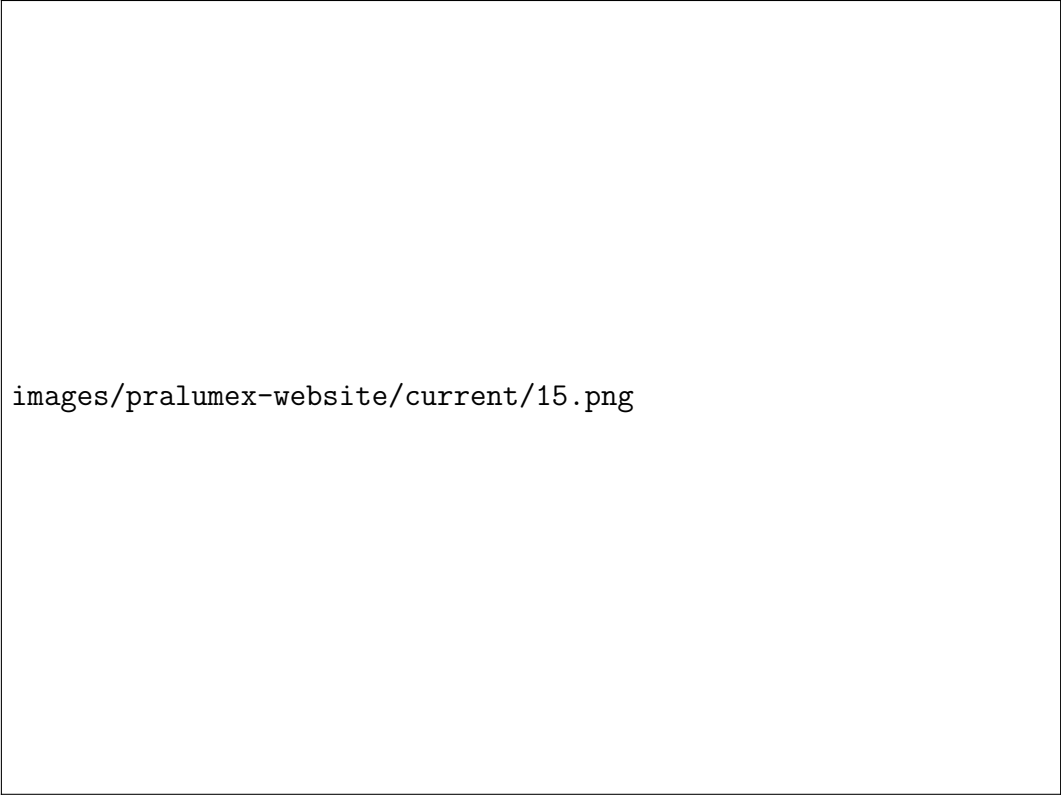
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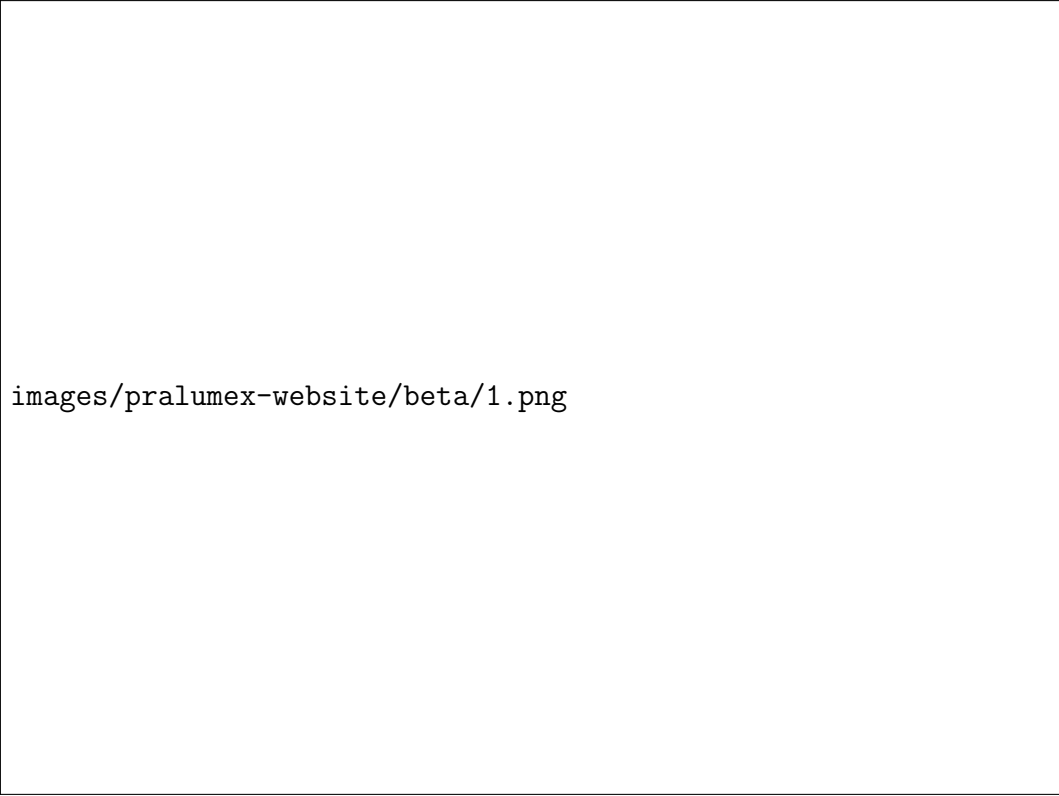


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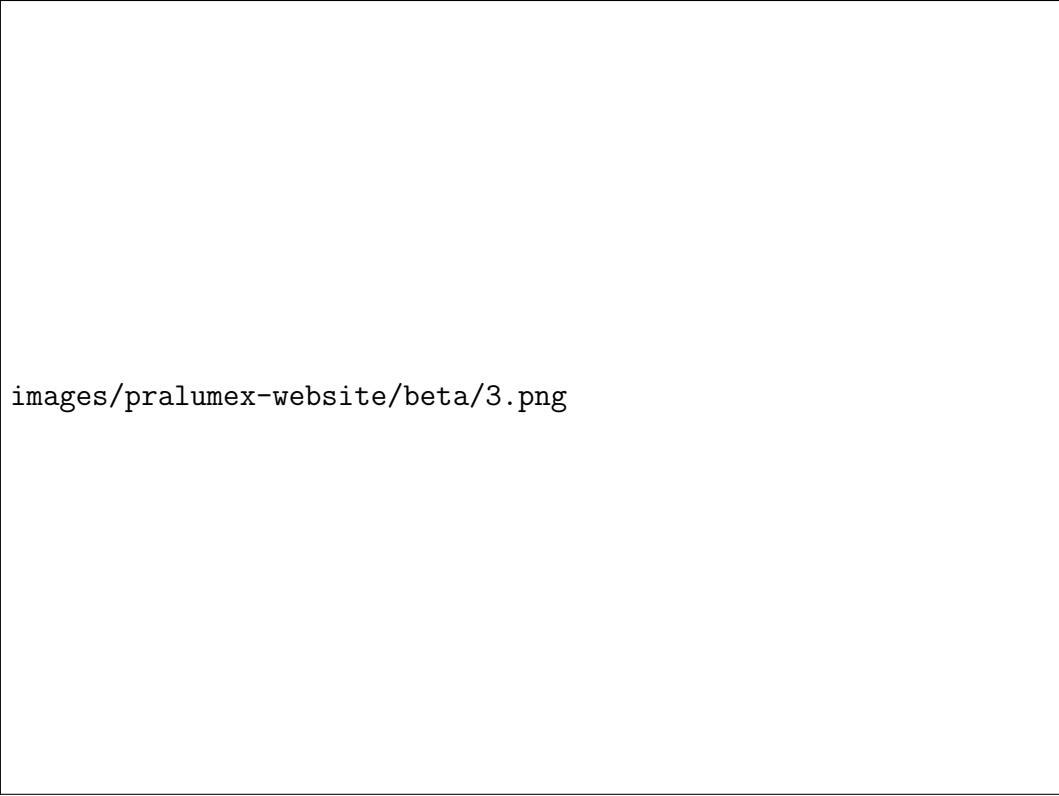
3.5.3 E.3 — Beta Site (beta.pralumex.com)



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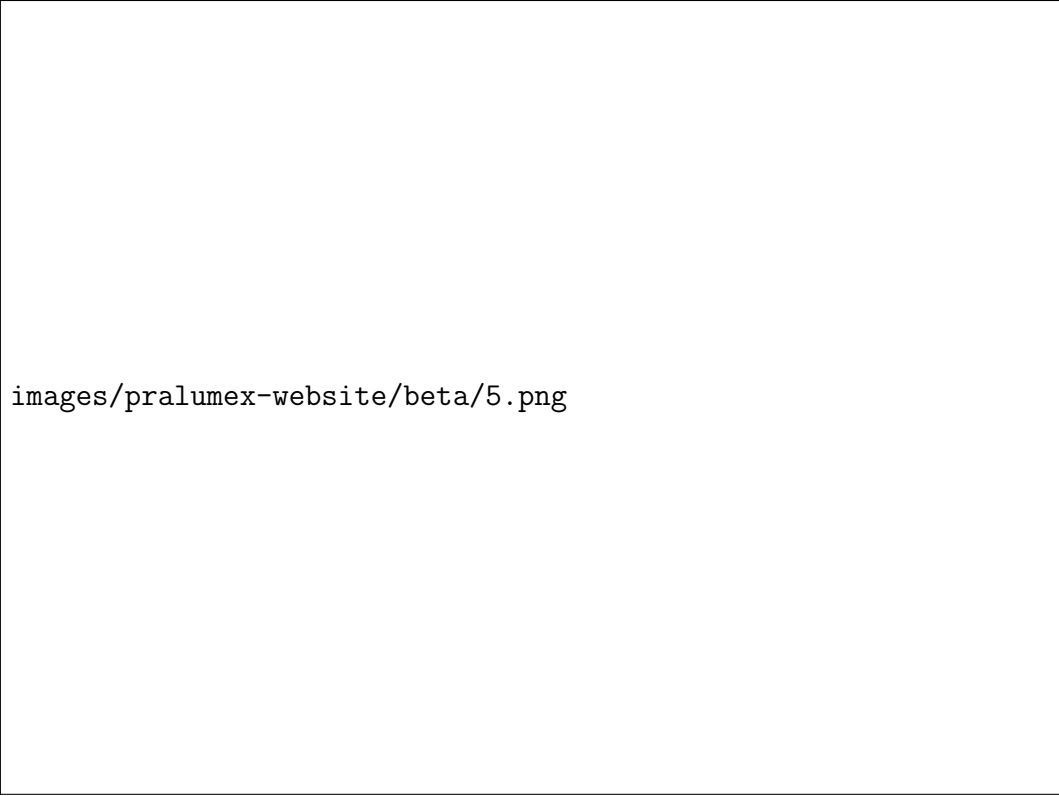
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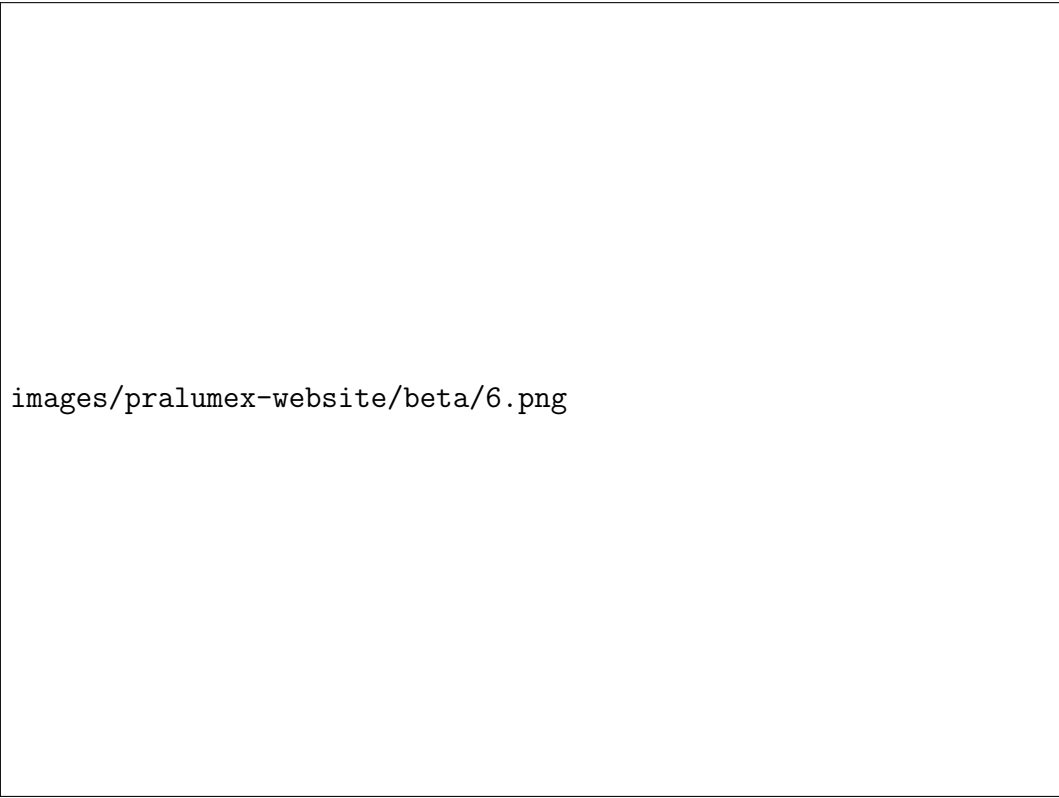
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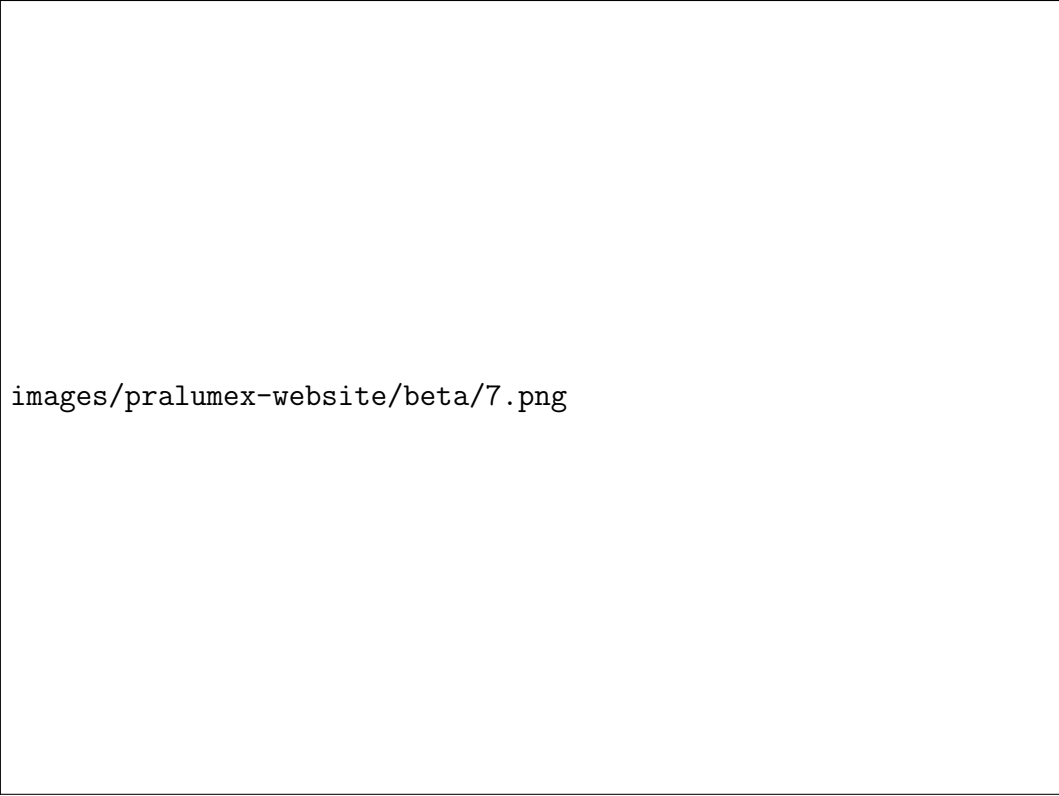
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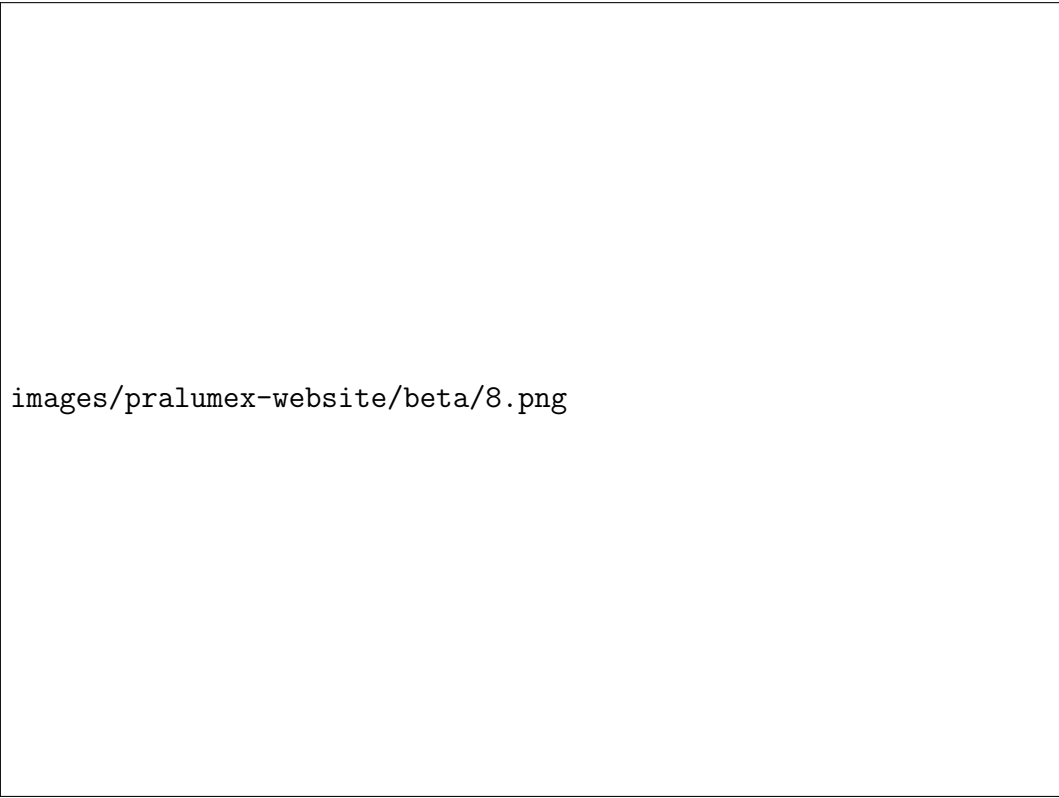
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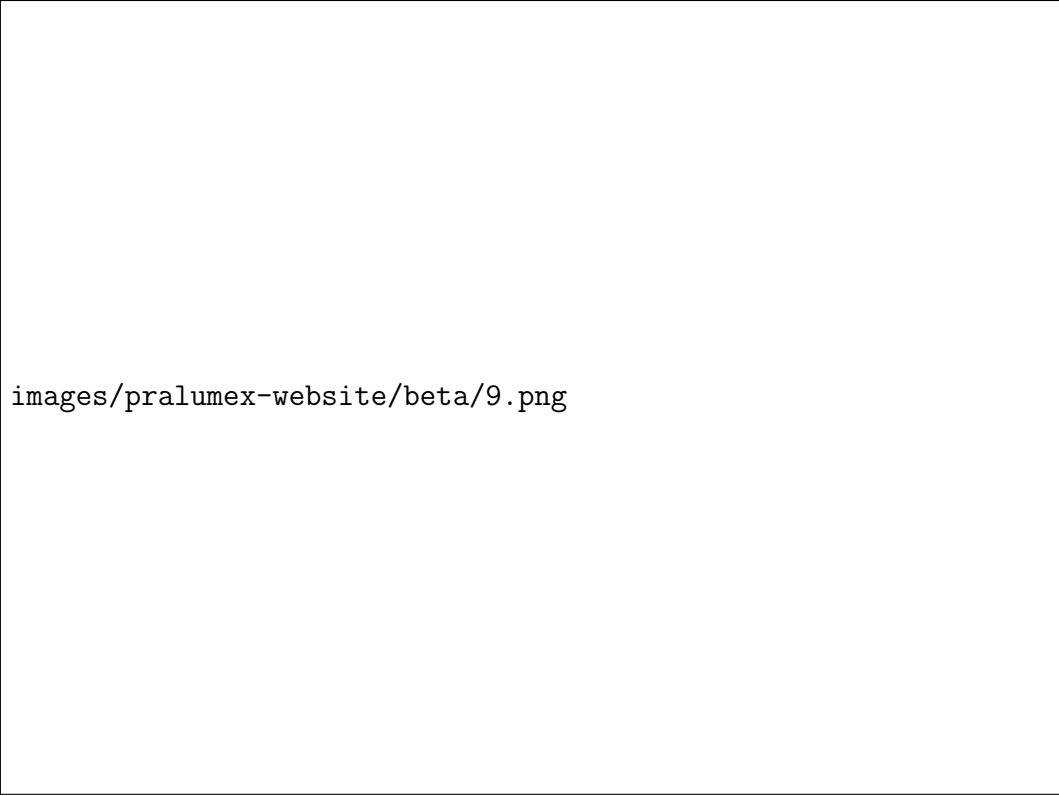
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images/pralumex-website/beta/9.png



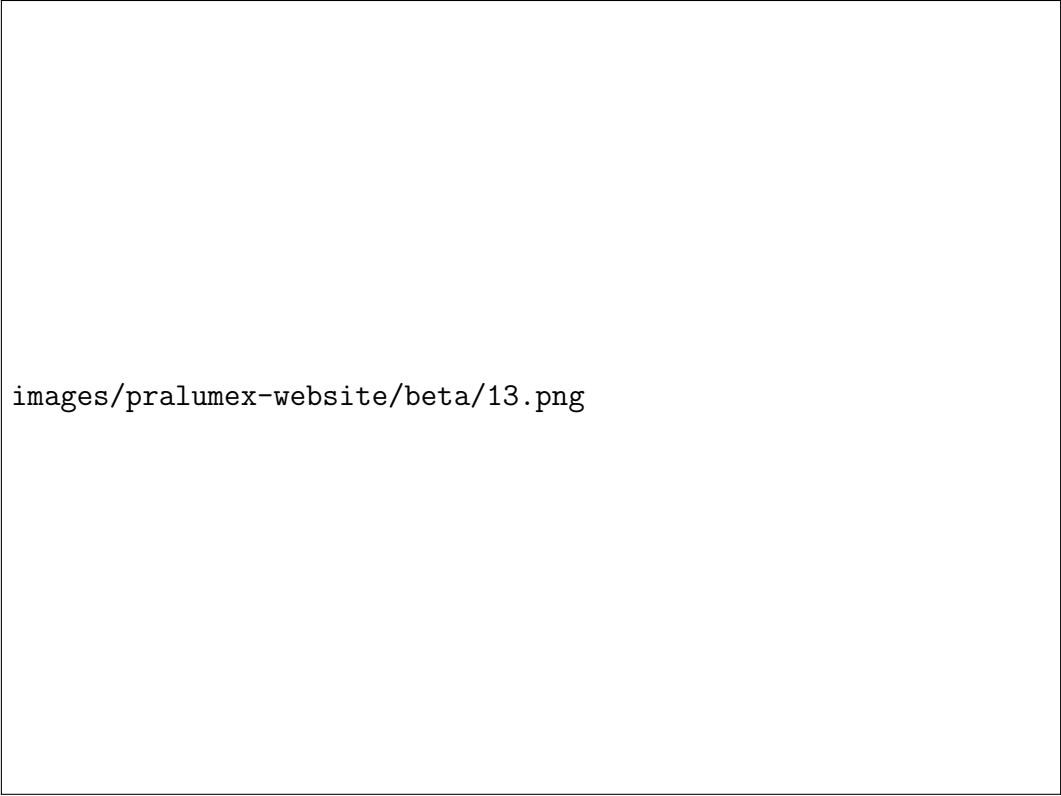
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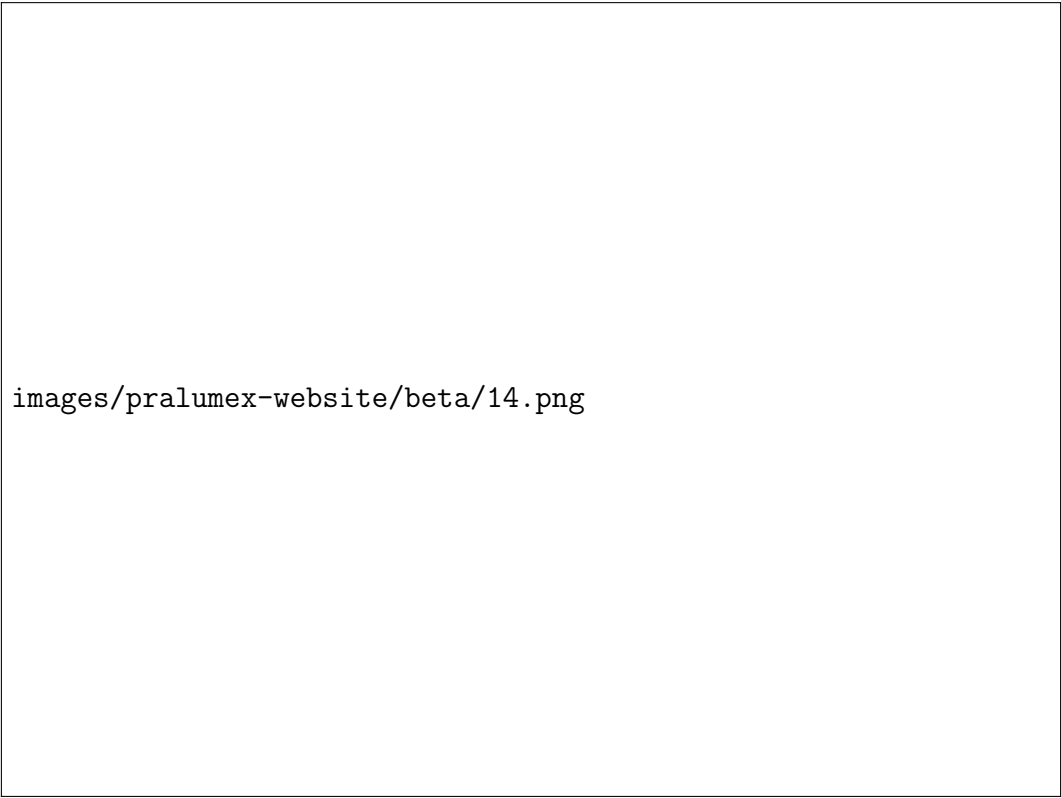
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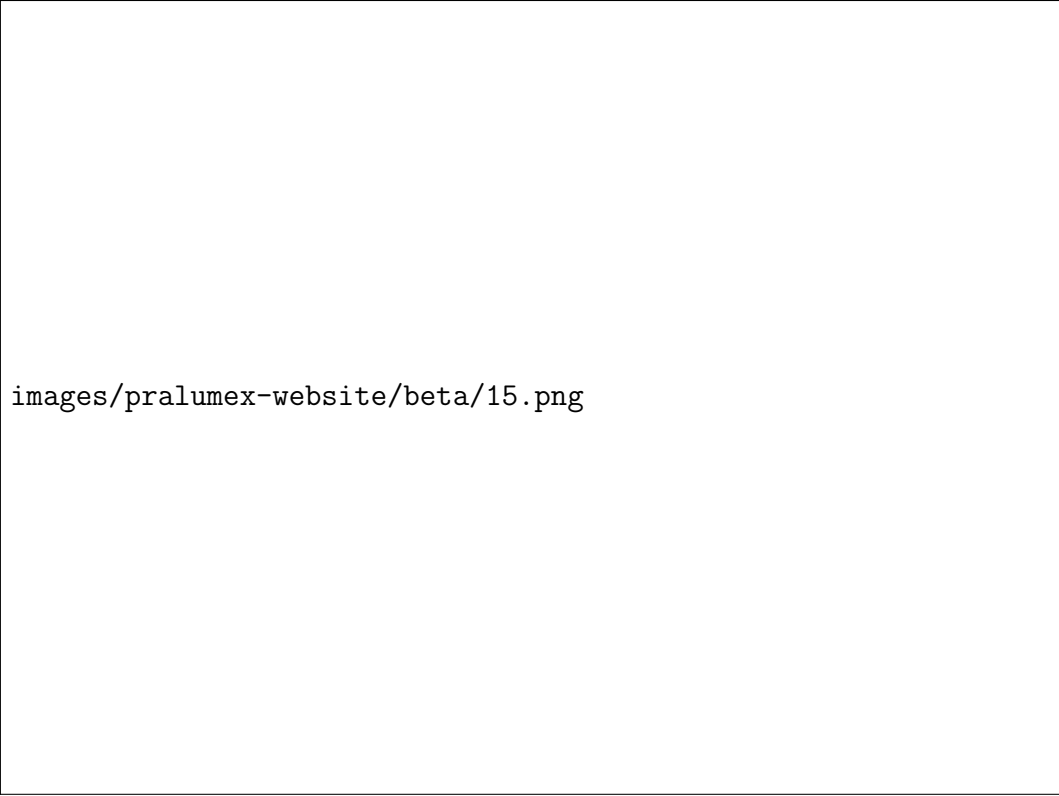
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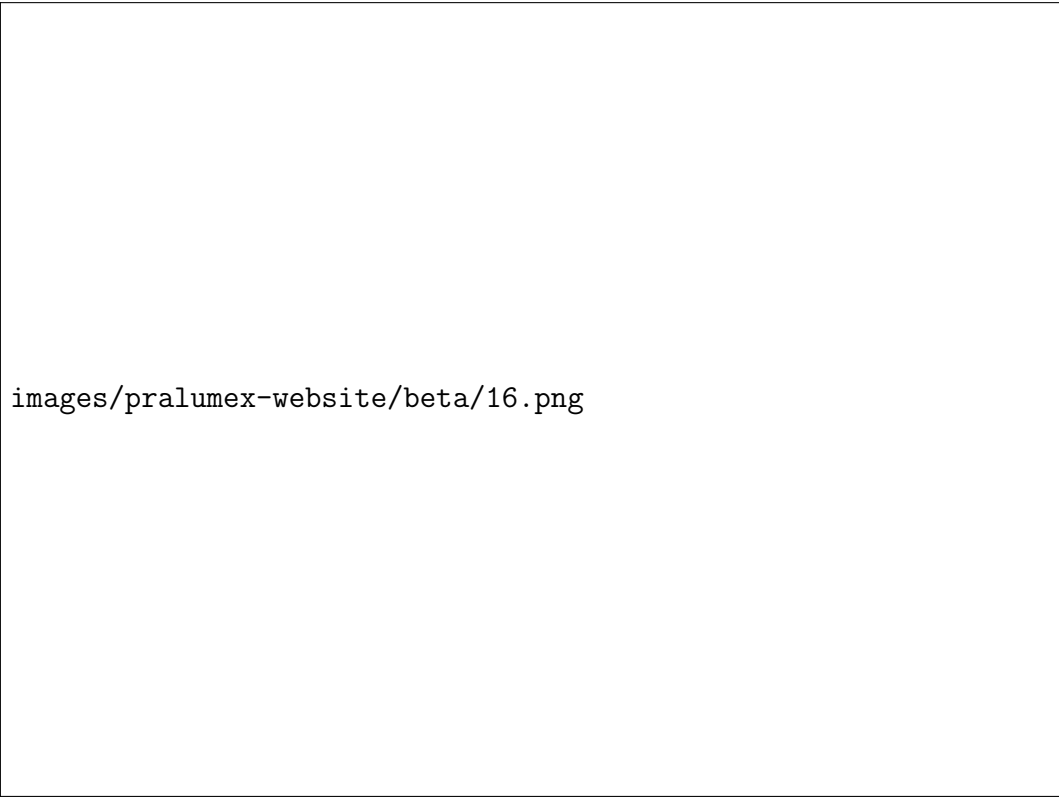
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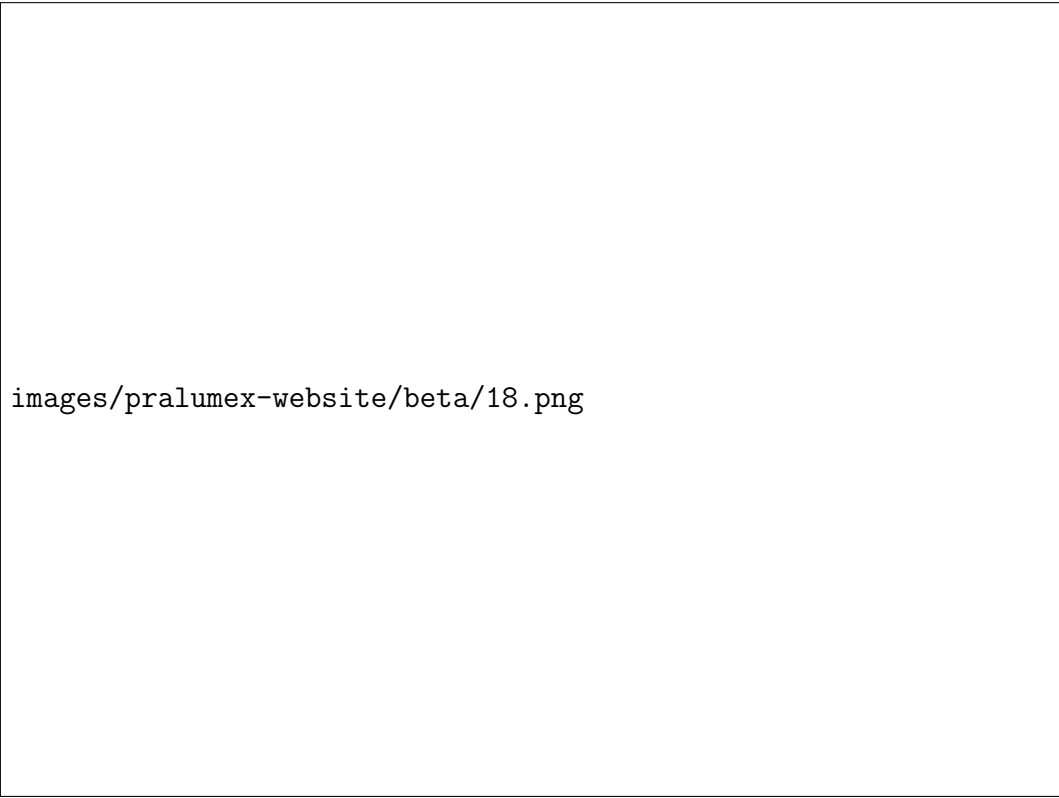
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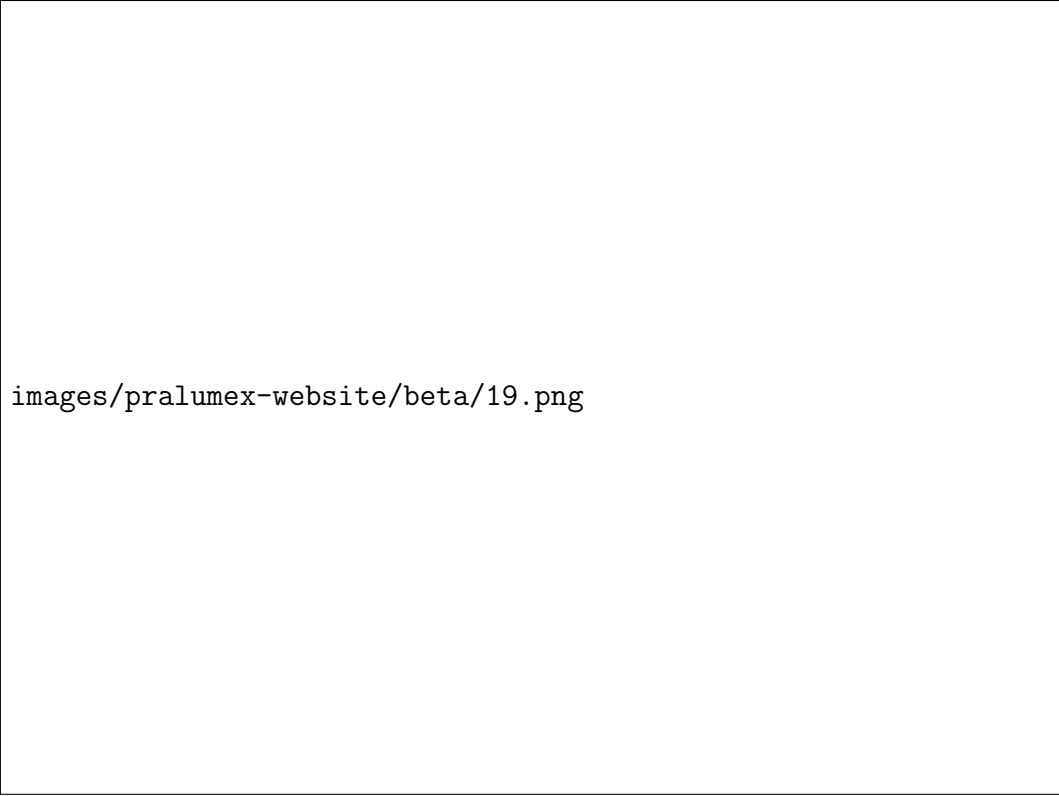
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images/pralumex-website/beta/18.png



images/pralumex-website/beta/19.png



images/pralumex-website/beta/20.png



images/pralumex-website/beta/21.png



images/pralumex-website/beta/22.png

3.6 Appendix F: Frontend Design & UI/UX Videos & Sources

3.6.1 React UI Libraries

Title	Creator	Type	Platform
10 Best React UI Libraries for 2026	Codevolution	Video	YouTube
I Just Discovered The Most Under-rated UI Library for React	CoderOne	Video	YouTube
Mantine UI crash course with NEXT.JS — React UI Framework	Cules Coding	Video	YouTube

For the pralumex.com website I utilized Mantine UI, so I chose to do further research and development on it. I found it was open source and discovered amazing reviews on Reddit for a free UI library, which could get me jumpstarted quickly on building a polished interface.

3.7 Appendix G: Time Management & Productivity Habits Sources

3.7.1 Videos & Articles

Title	Creator	Type	Platform
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3.7.2 Timeboxing Calendar

3.8 Appendix H: Following Software & Technology Content Sources

3.8.1 Fireship

Title	Creator	Type	Platform
Anthropic just bought your favorite JS runtime...	Fireship	Video	YouTube
React.js shell shocked by 10.0 critical vulnerability...	Fireship	Video	YouTube
OpenAI was dead... Then GPT-5.2 dropped	Fireship	Video	YouTube
.NET in 100 Seconds	Fireship	Video	YouTube
A brief history of programming...	Fireship	Video	YouTube
Bun in 100 Seconds	Fireship	Video	YouTube
The wild rise of OpenClaw...	Fireship	Video	YouTube
10 open source tools that feel illegal...	Fireship	Video	YouTube
How AI is breaking the SaaS business model...	Fireship	Video	YouTube
TanStack Start in 100 Seconds	Fireship	Video	YouTube
When open-sourcing your code goes wrong...	Fireship	Video	YouTube
Cloudflare just slop forked Next.js...	Fireship	Video	YouTube
The greatest unsolved problem in computer science...	Fireship	Video	YouTube
7 new open source AI tools you need right now...	Fireship	Video	YouTube
How to burn \$30m on a JavaScript framework...	Fireship	Video	YouTube
Google just changed the future of UI/UX design...	Fireship	Video	YouTube
This new Linux distro is breaking the law, by design...	Fireship	Video	YouTube
Tech bros optimized war... and it's working	Fireship	Video	YouTube
Anthropic just released the real Claude Bot...	Fireship	Video	YouTube
Millions of JS devs just got penetrated by a RAT...	Fireship	Video	YouTube
Tragic mistake... Anthropic leaks Claude's source code	Fireship	Video	YouTube
He just crawled through hell to fix the browser...	Fireship	Video	YouTube

Title	Creator	Type	Platform
Cursor ditches VS Code, but not everyone is happy...	Fireship	Video	YouTube
Google just casually disrupted the open-source AI narrative...	Fireship	Video	YouTube
Claude Mythos is too dangerous for public consumption...	Fireship	Video	YouTube
Millions of WordPress sites just got hacked... again	Fireship	Video	YouTube
Claude just got another superpower...	Fireship	Video	YouTube
I finally found a use case for OpenClaw...	Fireship	Video	YouTube

3.8.2 Miscellaneous

Title	Creator	Type	Platform
Your Favorite YouTube Channel is Micro (Probably) Owned By Private Equity	Micro	Video	YouTube

3.9 Appendix I: Aviation Sources

3.9.1 Pilot Debrief

Title	Creator	Type	Platform
Pilot's Reckless Mistakes Kills Family AGAIN!	Pilot Debrief	Video	YouTube
YouTube Pilot's Deadly Mistake Was Worse Than We Thought!	Pilot Debrief	Video	YouTube
Pilot's Vegas Night Out Gets 6 People Killed!	Pilot Debrief	Video	YouTube
Death by Flight Instructor!	Pilot Debrief	Video	YouTube
The IMPOSSIBLE TURN That Killed a Pilot Legend!	Pilot Debrief	Video	YouTube
The Most Disturbing Pilot Mistake I've Ever Talked About!	Pilot Debrief	Video	YouTube

3.9.2 National Transportation Safety Board (NTSB)

Title	Creator	Type	Platform
Midair Collision PSA Airlines Bombardier CRJ700 Airplane and Sikorsky UH-60 Military Helicopter	NTSB	Report	NTSB
In-Flight Separation of Left Mid Exit Door Plug, Alaska Airlines Flight 1282, Boeing 737-9, N704AL	NTSB	Report	NTSB
Investigation of Lion Air Flight 610 and Ethiopian Airlines Flight 302	NTSB	Report	NTSB